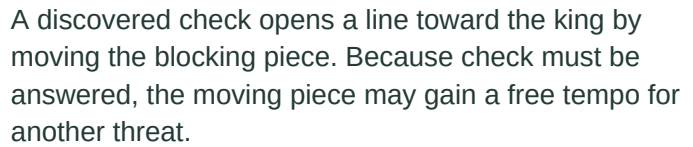


Discovered checks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

Previous move: 46...Rc3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

47. Rb8+ Kh7 48. fxe6+ Rxc2 49. e7

48.fxe6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on c2 attacks the king on h7. Recorded reply: **48...Rxc2**.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -1 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.